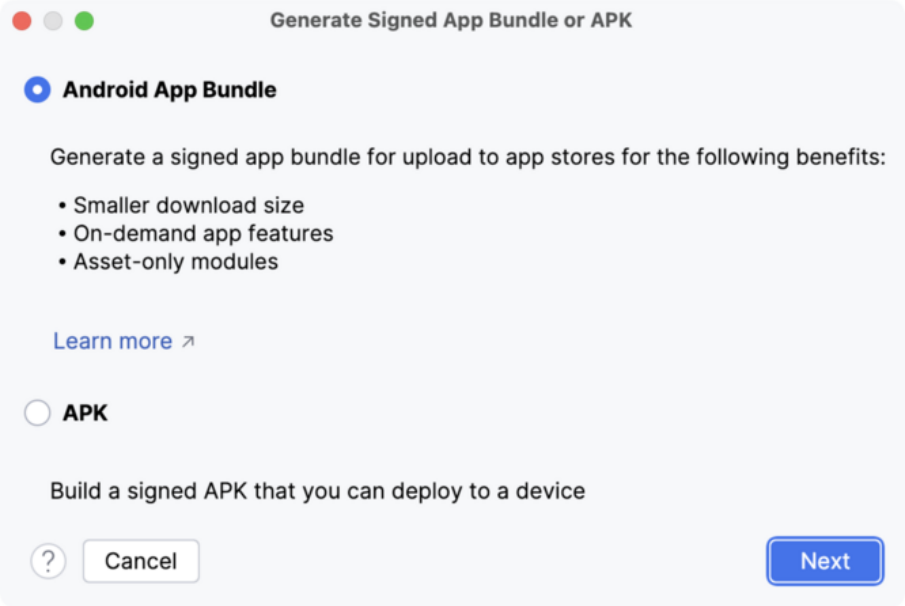
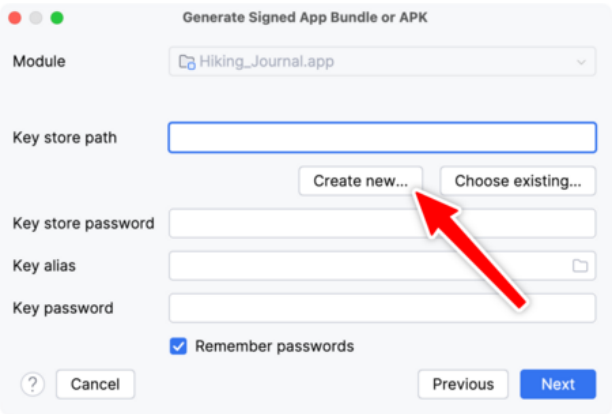


The next screen prompts you for something called a *key store*. An Android key store is a secure storage container that verifies the authenticity of your app. Google Play uses it to verify that updates come from the original developer—you. Apps signed with a key store are also harder to modify and redistribute maliciously.

Generate a new key store by clicking Create new….



I keep my key store in the same directory as my Android project and add it to `.gitignore` so it doesn't get checked in with the code. I also use the same password for the key store and the key itself—one less thing to forget. Populate these along with at least one field under the Certificate fieldset. I